



Pre-Reads

14-Day AI Accelerator Program

Pre-Reads

Session Name: Advanced MCPs & workflow

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Chapter 1: What You Will Learn

1.1 Introduction to MCP Modes

In this session, we will dive into the **advanced stages of Model Context Protocols (MCP)** — the technology that allows AI systems like Claude, ChatGPT, and agents to plug into external tools, APIs, databases, memory systems, and more.

You will understand the **four levels (modes)** of MCP usage:

Easy Mode

- Uses **web connectors** inside platforms like **ChatGPT** or **Claude**.
- Very simple: click, connect, and use tools directly from the browser.
- Unlocks **~100–200 MCP servers**.

Medium Mode

- Uses **desktop connectors** (Claude Desktop, Cloud Desktop).
- Still fairly simple, but requires using MCP connectors like **file systems** via a cloud desktop.
- Unlocks **~200 MCP servers**.
- **Free** to use.

Hard Mode

- Unlocks **2,000+ MCP servers** using [Smithery.ai](https://smithery.ai).
- Not “hard” in terms of execution, but it requires careful attention to the necessary steps.
- You’ll learn how to **install MCP servers** like:
 - **Context 7**
 - **Perplexity MCP**
 - **Mem0** (for memory systems)
- You’ll also use [Smithery.ai](https://smithery.ai) to connect MCP servers to:
 - **Claude Desktop**
 - **Cursor**

- **ChatGPT**
- **Gemini**
- **VS Code**

Ultra Mode

- Unlocks **16,000+ MCP servers**
- Involves using a **config file** in **Claude Desktop**
- You'll learn how to:
 - Generate config files using **LLMs** (like Perplexity).
 - Merge multiple MCP server setups.
 - Add API keys and configure the system to work with several servers simultaneously.

This session will focus entirely on **unlocking Hard Mode and Ultra Mode**.

1.2 Tools Covered in This Session

You will work with the following tools and technologies:

- **MCP (Model Context Protocol)**: This protocol allows AI agents to **retain memory** and context across multiple interactions, helping them learn from previous conversations and improve decision-making.
- **n8n**: A no-code platform for creating workflows that automate tasks and connect various apps and tools.
- **[Smithery.ai](#)**: A tool for creating and managing **custom MCP servers** and integrating them with your AI agents.
- **Claude Desktop**: Required for installing and managing **MCP servers** (specifically for **Hard Mode** and **Ultra Mode** installations).
- **Node.js**: A runtime that is necessary to execute MCP server calls and run advanced workflows.

Chapter 2: Prerequisites

2.1 Tools You Will Use in This Session

Before the session, please ensure the following tools are set up:

1. [Smithery.ai](#)

What it is: [Smithery.ai](#) provides access to a vast library of **MCP servers** (2,471+). You'll use this platform to unlock **Hard Mode** and **Ultra Mode**.

Step-by-Step Setup:

1. Visit [Smithery.ai Website](#).
 2. **Sign up** using your **Gmail account**.
 3. Log in to access the library of MCP servers and start building your custom workflows.
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2. Claude Desktop

What it is: Claude Desktop is needed to **install and manage MCP servers** for **Hard Mode** and **Ultra Mode**.

Step-by-Step Setup:

1. Visit [Claude AI Website](#).
2. Download and install **Claude Desktop** for **Mac** or **Windows**.
3. Log in and configure the software to connect and run MCP servers.

3. Node.js

What it is: A runtime environment required for executing MCP server commands.

Step-by-Step Setup:

1. Visit [Node.js Website](#).
 2. Download and install the **LTS version** of Node.js.
 3. Ensure Node.js and npm (Node Package Manager) are installed and ready.
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2.2 Basic Knowledge and Familiarity

- **No coding skills required:** You'll be using **n8n's no-code interface** to build workflows and automate tasks.
 - **Familiarity with basic terms** like **APIs**, **workflows**, and **servers** will help, but we'll guide you through everything step-by-step.
 - Understanding **task automation** concepts will help you follow the session more easily.
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Chapter 3: Key Takeaways Before the Session

3.1 What to Expect in the Session

- **Hands-on learning:** This session will be a **deep dive** into advanced **MCP usage** with **n8n** and [Smithery.ai](#).
- **You'll configure and install MCP servers** like **Context 7**, **Perplexity**, and **Mem0** for use in **Hard Mode** and **Ultra Mode**.
- **AI Agent Memory:** Learn how to build smarter agents by adding **memory** and **contextual awareness** to improve the agent's ability to perform tasks over time.

- **Advanced Integration:** Connect **MCP servers** to tools like **Claude** and **ChatGPT** to enhance your agent's functionality.

3.2 Summary Checklist

- **Sign up** for [Smithery.ai](#), **Claude Desktop**, and **Node.js**.
- **Install** all required tools: **Node.js**, and **Claude Desktop**.
- **Familiarise yourself** with the idea of **MCP servers** and their role in adding memory and context to AI agents.
- Be ready to **dive into Hard Mode and Ultra Mode** with [Smithery.ai](#) and **n8n**.